

Progettazione di Applicazioni Mobili

Mobile design patterns

Design guidelines

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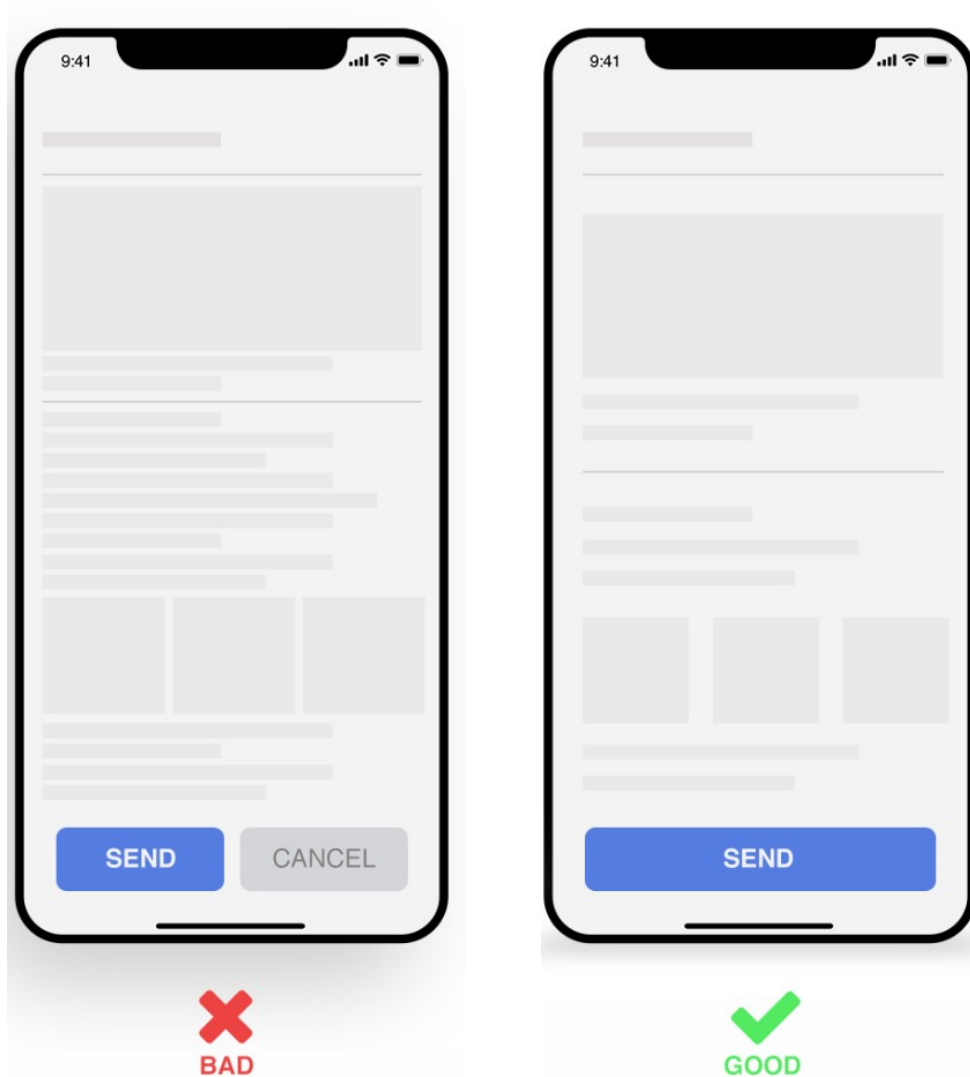
Dipartimento di Scienze Matematiche, Informatiche e
Fisiche - Università di Udine

stefano.burigat@uniud.it

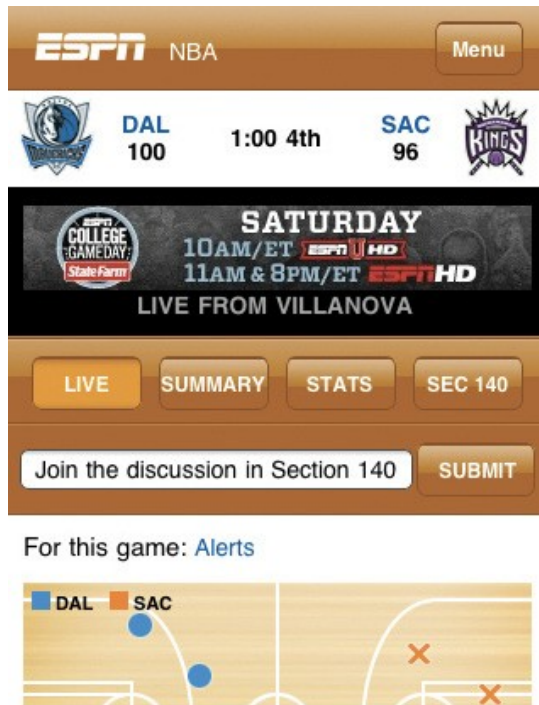


Keep your designs clean and consistent

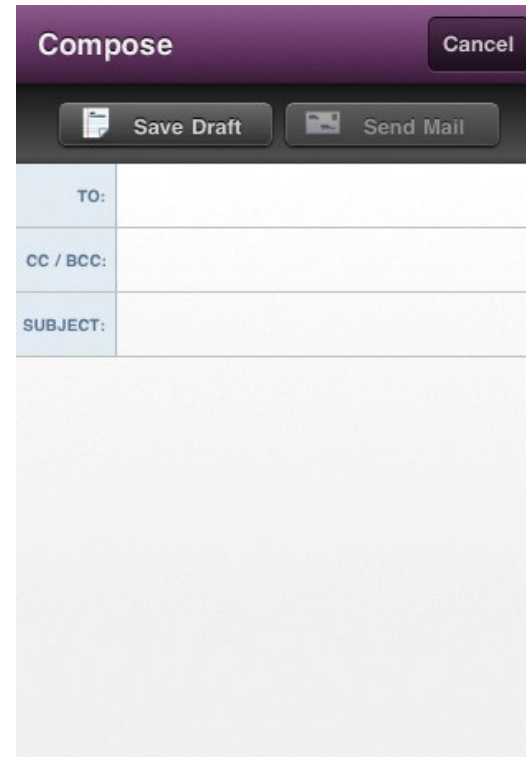
Overloaded
page



Main content pushed off the screen



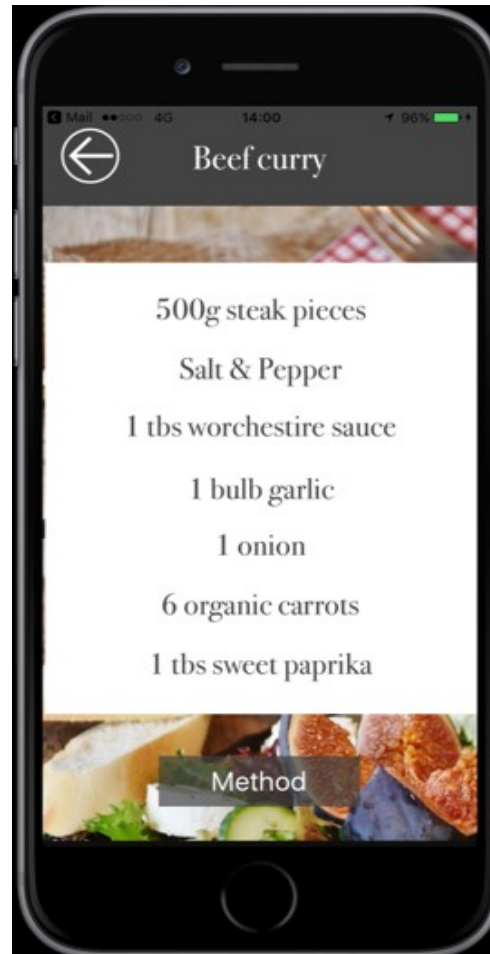
Interface laser-focused on the task at hand



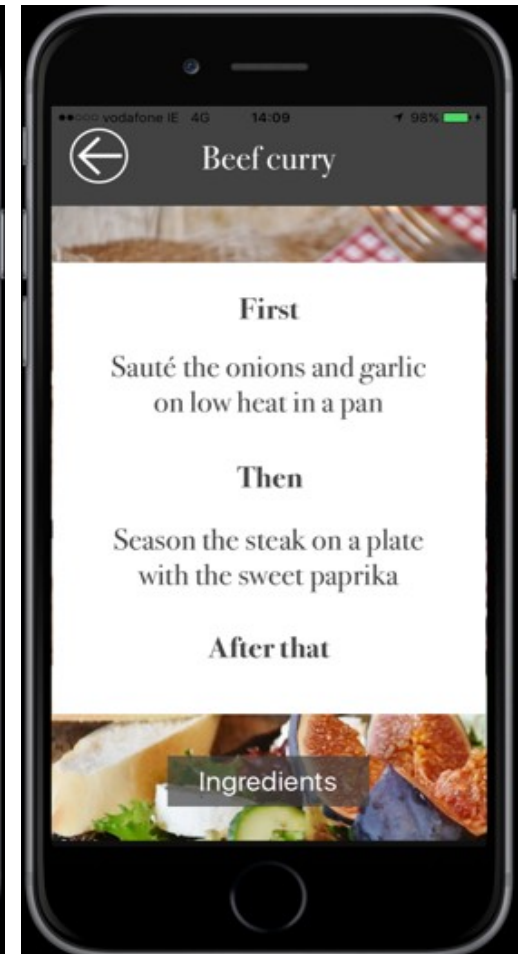
let people focus on their primary task by reducing the amount of navigation choices and chrome



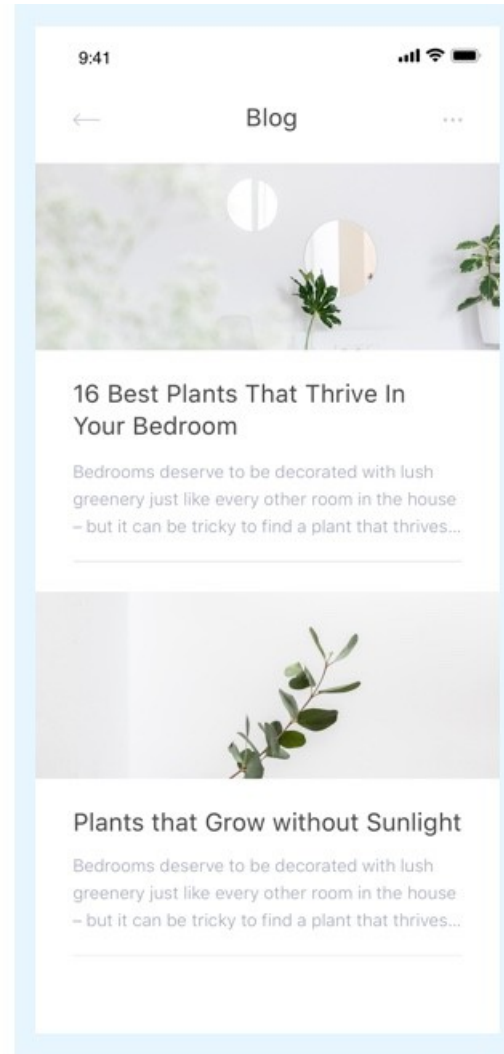
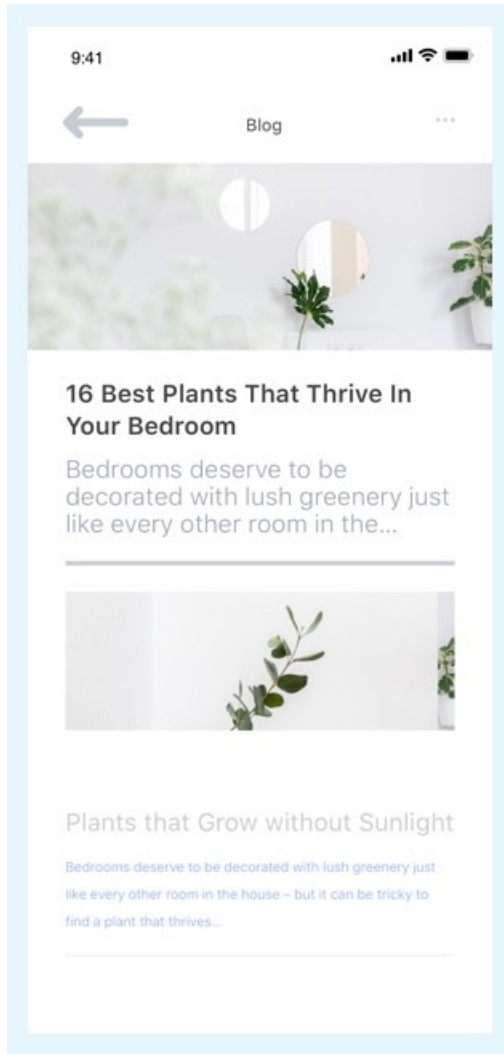
Before: overloaded single page content



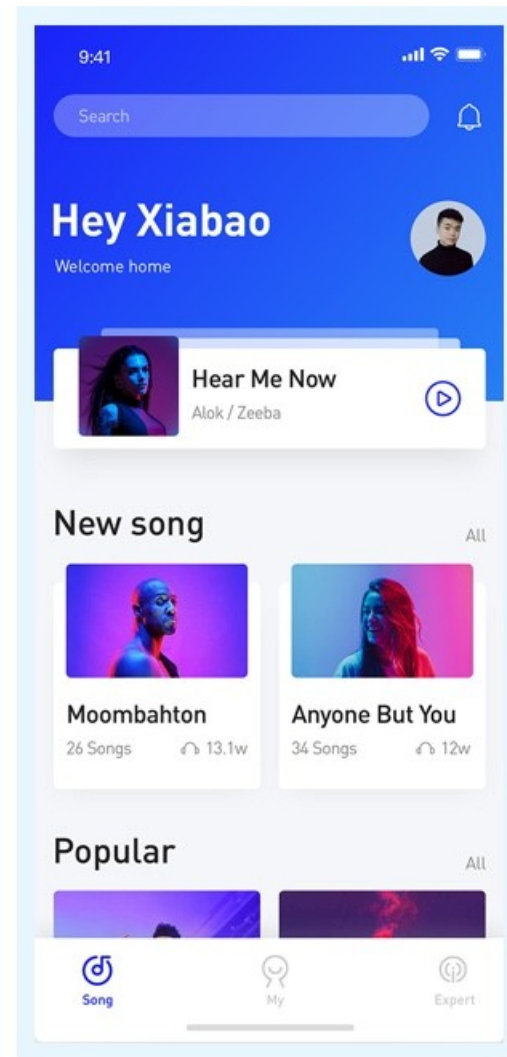
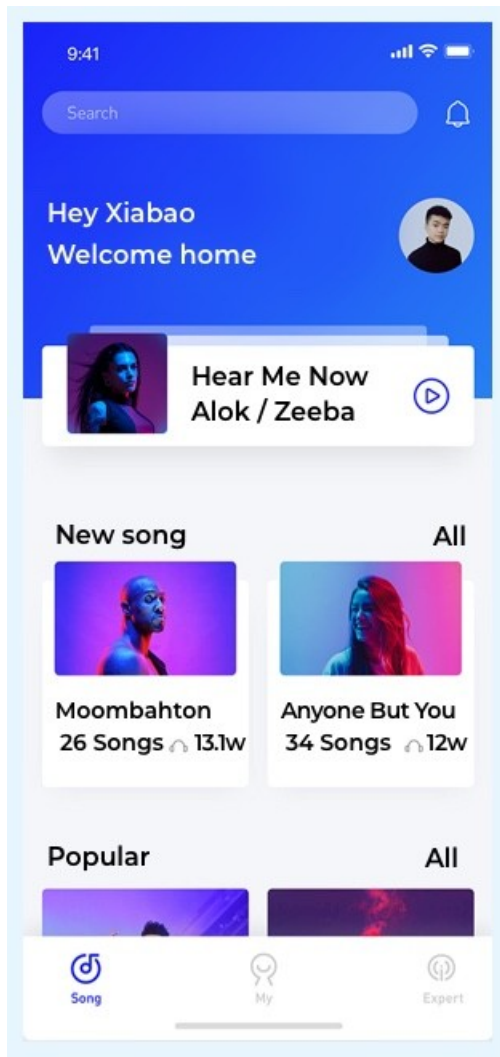
After: clean multi-page design



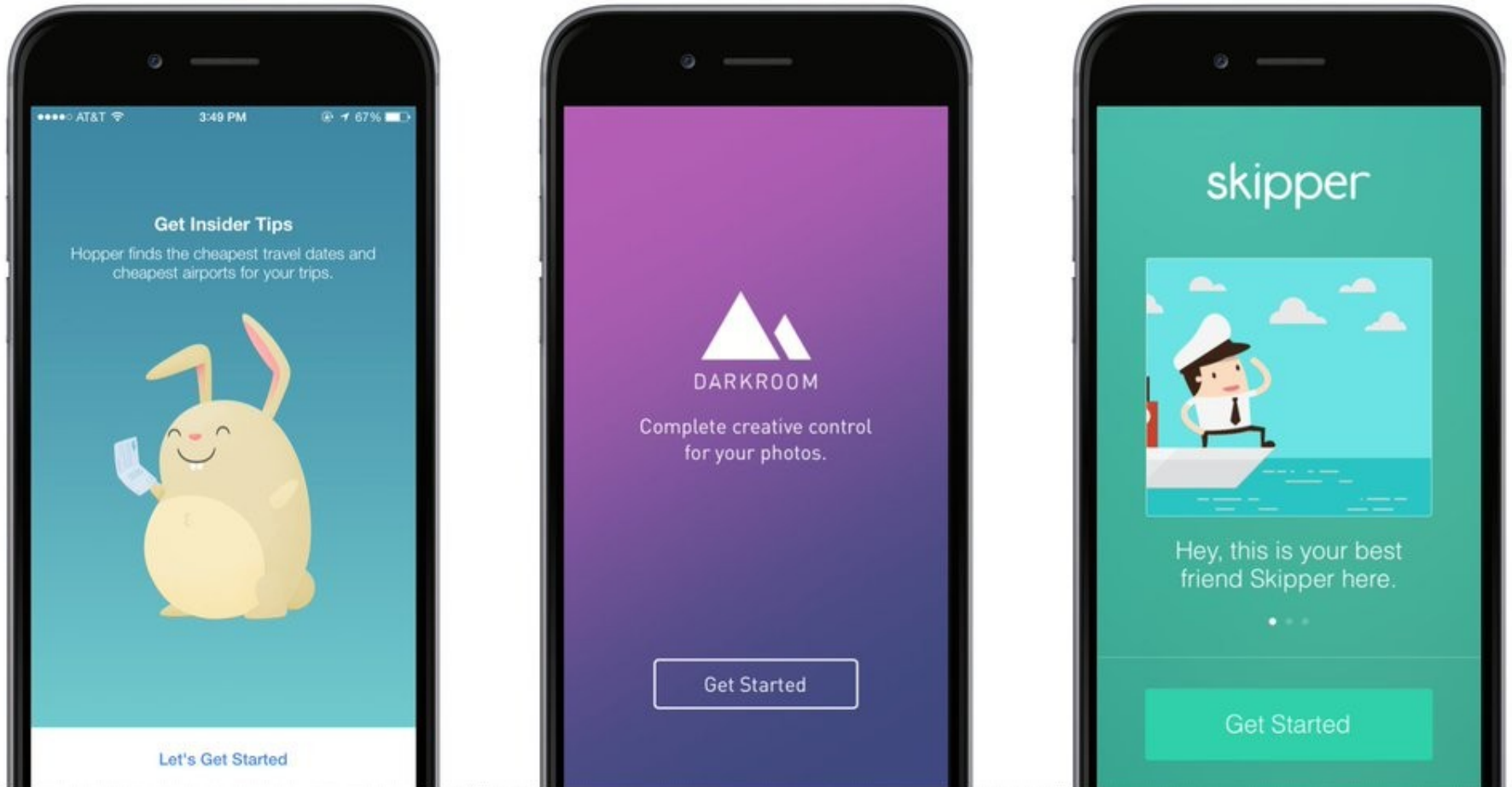
Inconsistent
use of fonts,
colors, sizes



Lack of text hierarchy



Minimize interaction blocks



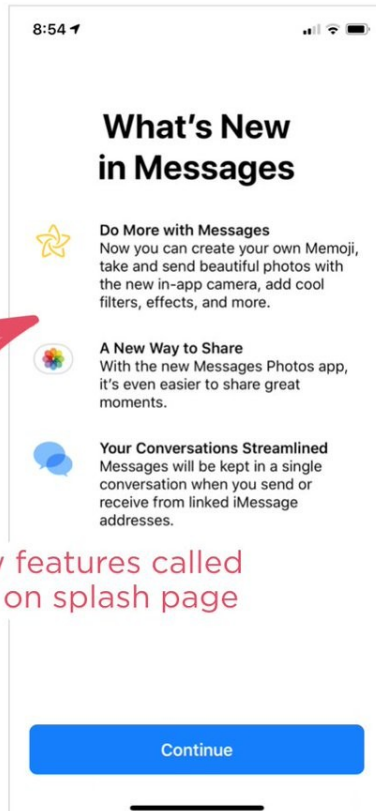
LUKEW
IDEATION + DESIGN

no better way to major user drop-offs than static app start/splash screens

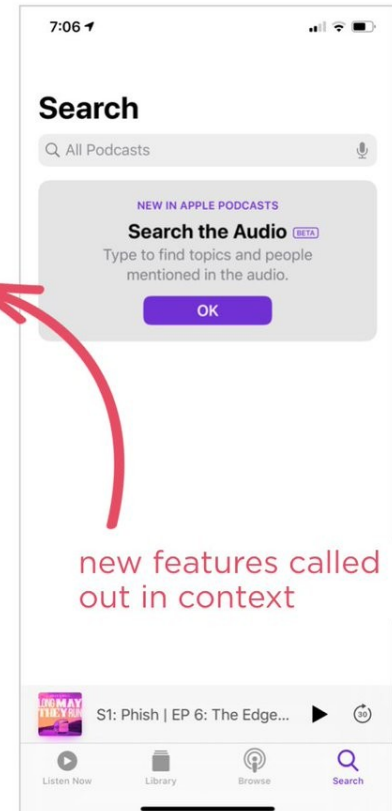
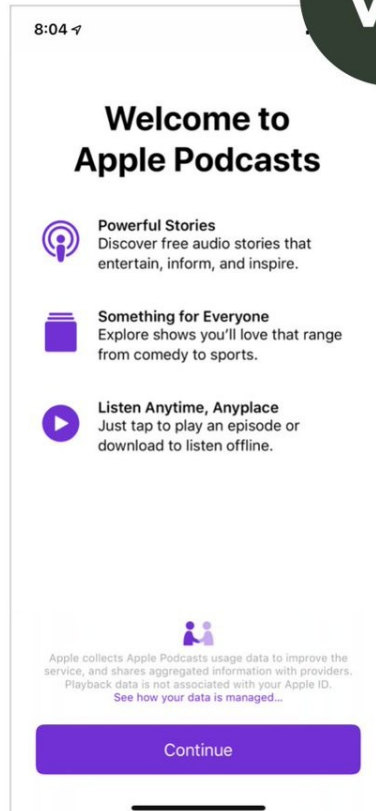
BEFORE

VS

AFTER

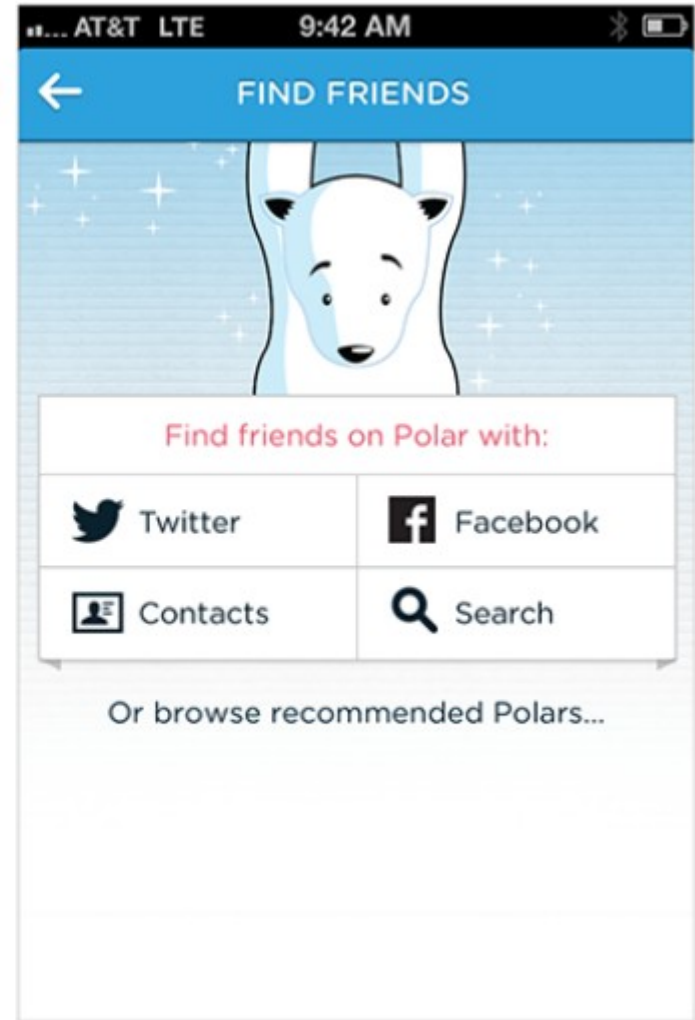
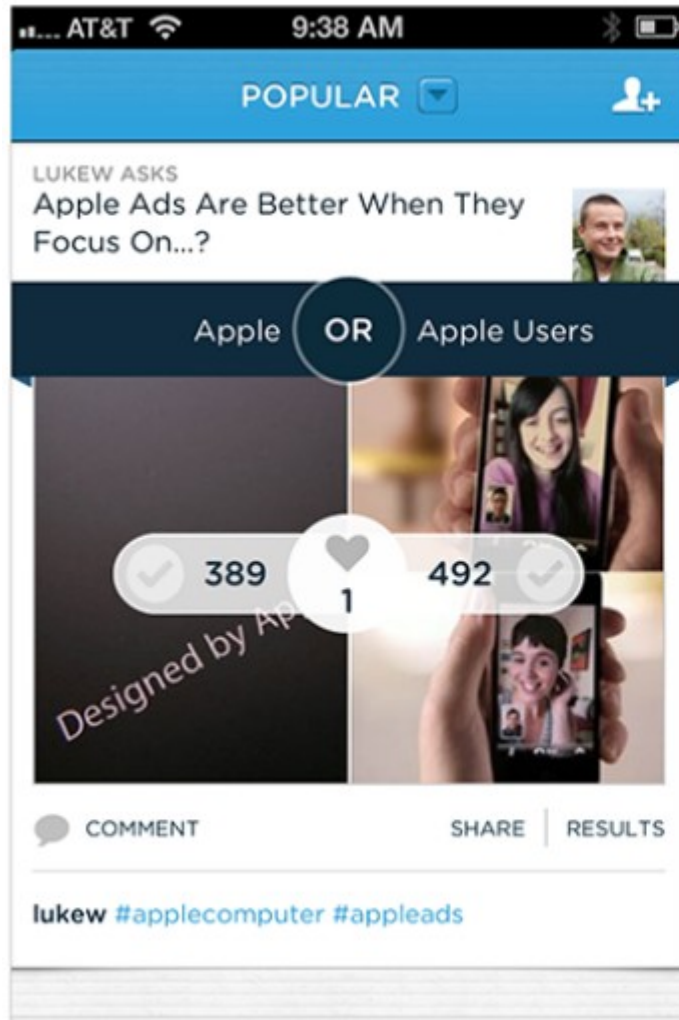


new features called out on splash page

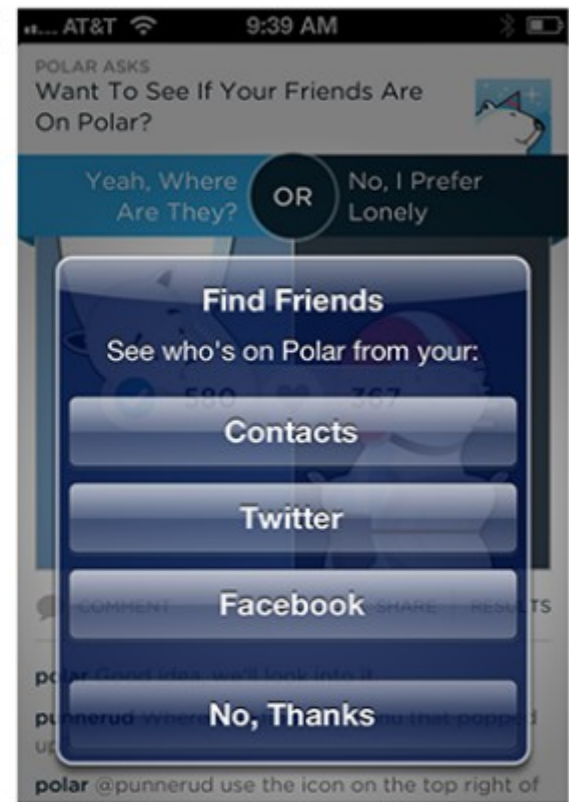
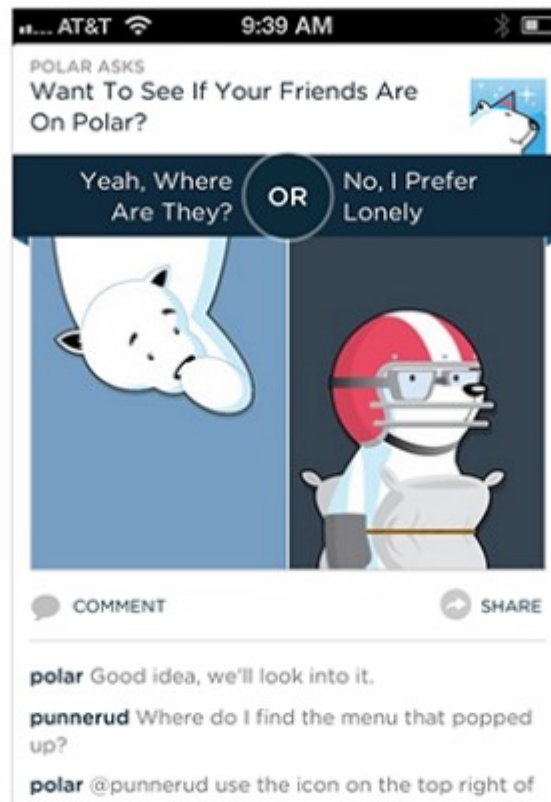
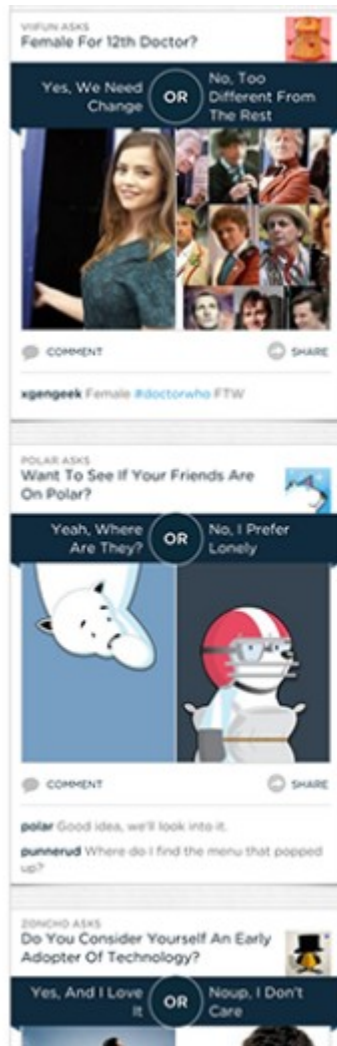


new features called out in context

new features on splash screen: replace with just in time education
(teach in the moment when specific information is actually useful)

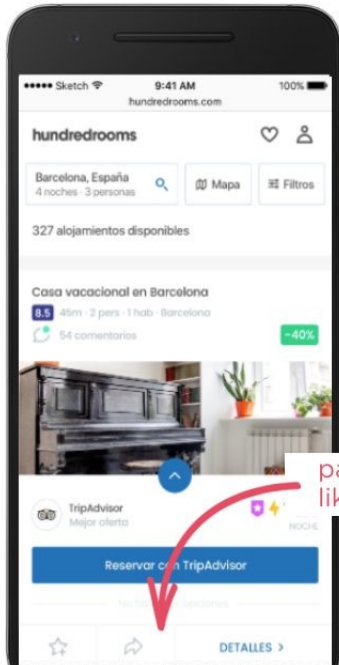


before: requiring people to go to a different part of the application to do secondary activities



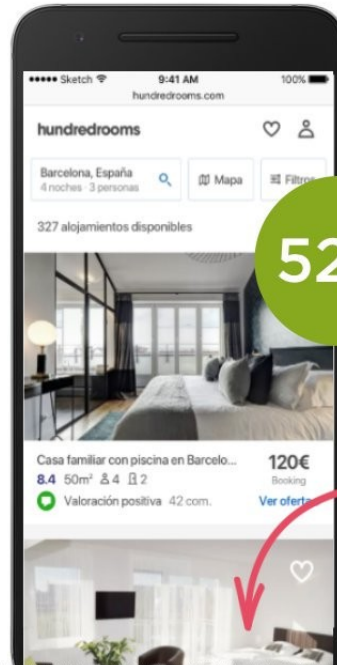
after: treating secondary activities as part of the main activity of the app

BEFORE



page looks like it ends

AFTER

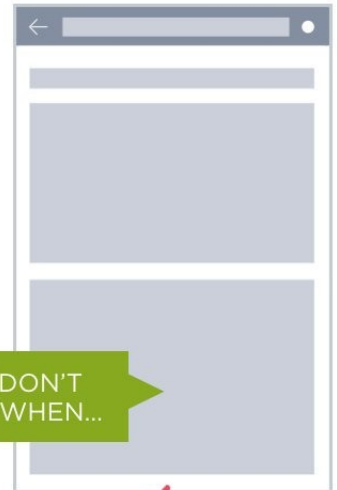


page looks like it continues

52%

INCREASE IN SALES
CONVERSION

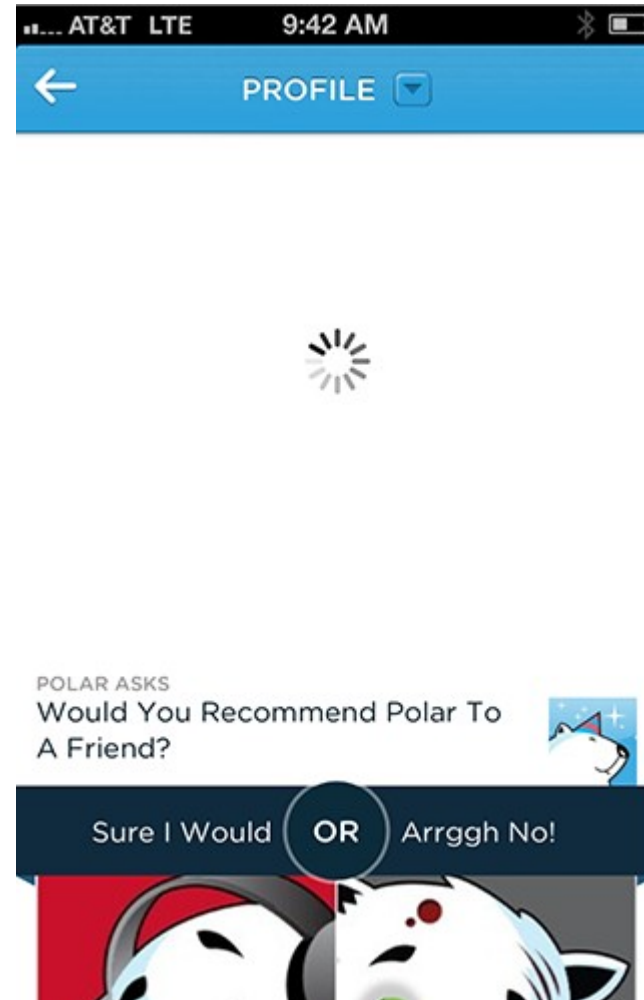
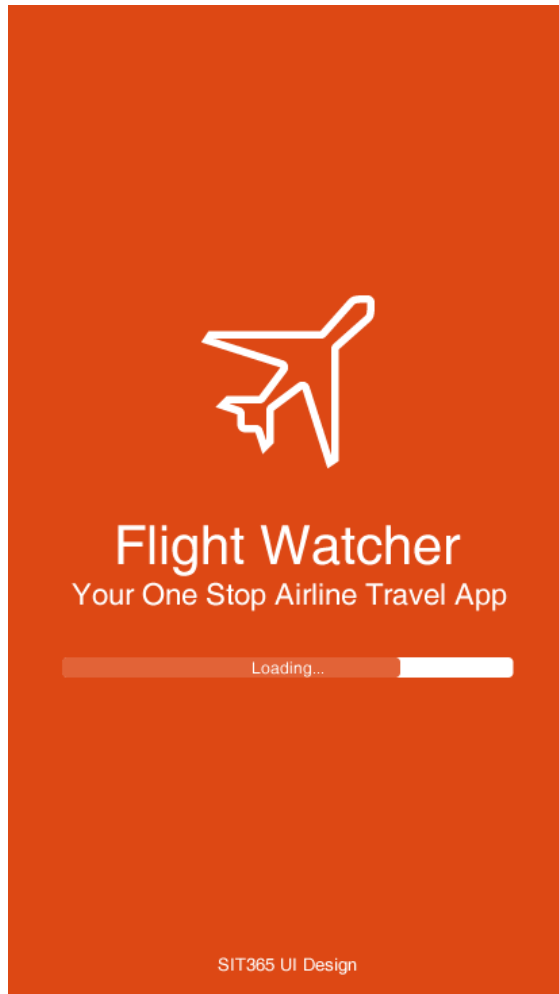
REMINDER



PEOPLE DON'T
SCROLL WHEN...

...content seems
to end due to
layout/design

if it "looks" like your UI ends, people won't scroll



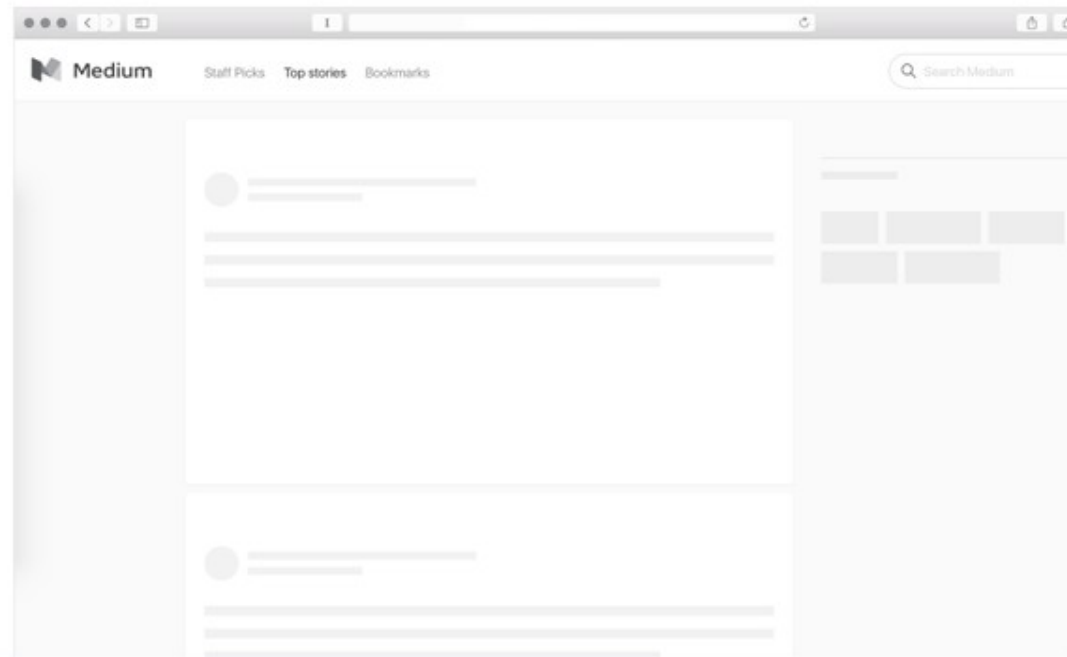
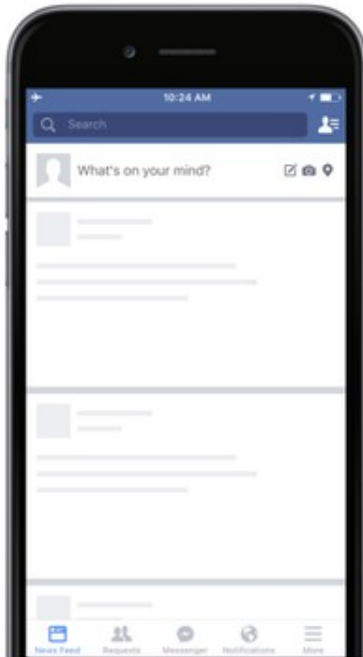
progress indicators by definition call attention to the fact that someone needs to wait

SKELETON SCREENS

FACEBOOK

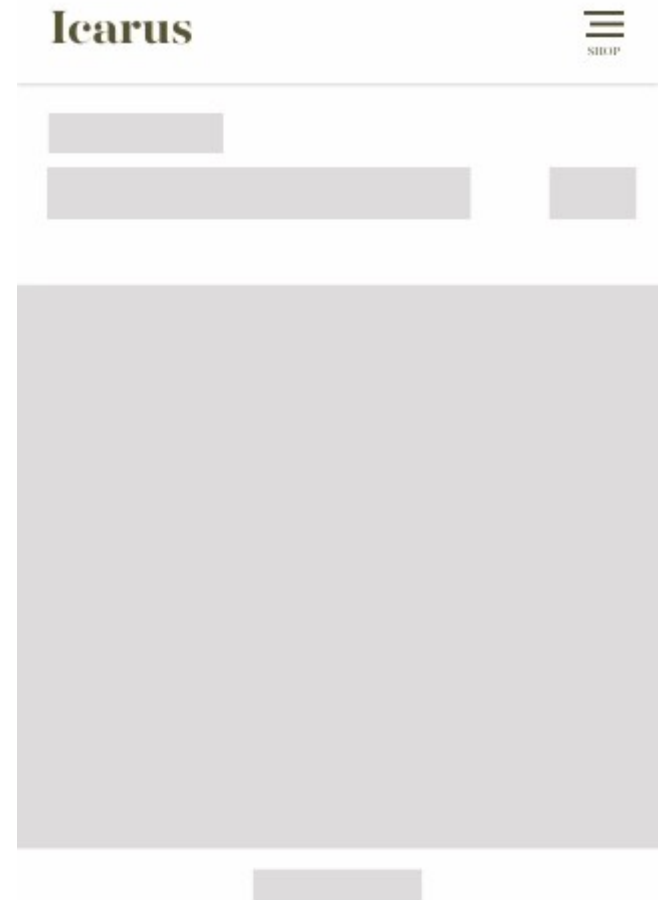
SLACK

MEDIUM



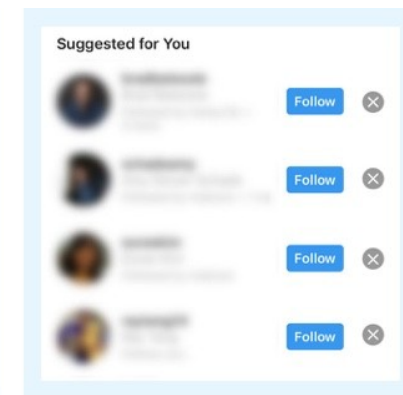
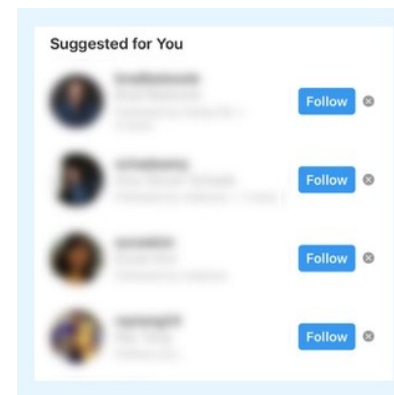
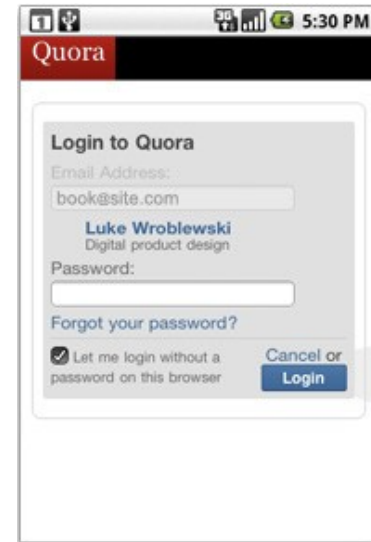
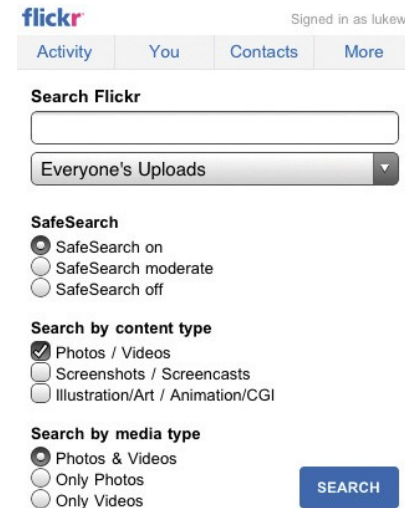
skeleton screens are a way to focus on progress instead of wait times while loading content

- Skeleton screens are perceived as being shorter in duration when compared against a blank screen and a spinner
- Skeleton screens should not block gradual content loads (real content should replace skeleton objects immediately when the data is available)
- Use motion (e.g. a wave or shimmer like animation) to further decrease perceived duration time

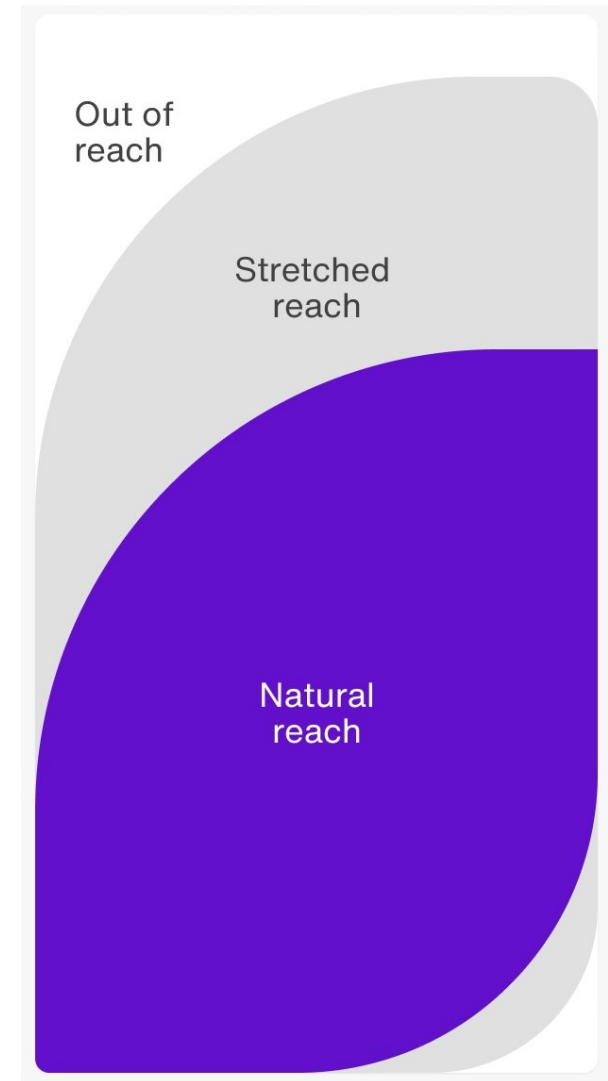


Size and placement of touch targets

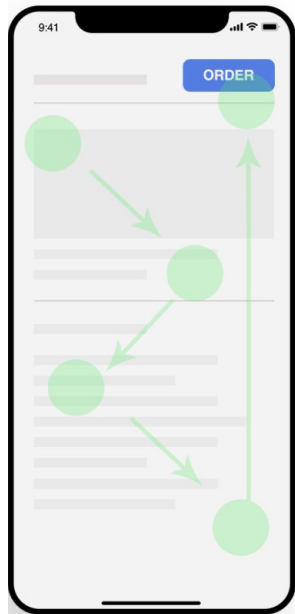
- Human fingers are imprecise pointing instruments
- Appropriately sized and placed touch targets can help people tap with confidence and accuracy
- Follow Apple/Google human interface guidelines for sizing touch targets
 - Apple: 44x44pts
 - Google: 48x48dps



- Actions toward the bottom of the device naturally align with how people hold and use their mobiles
- Optimizing for right-thumb actions is most common
- Primary actions can be placed in the middle or bottom of the screen and arranged from left to right
- Destructive actions like cancel or delete can be placed outside people's comfort zone



- Most users “scan” the mobile interface from top to bottom, left to right, so it’s better to place buttons in the bottom (right) of the screen



✗
BAD



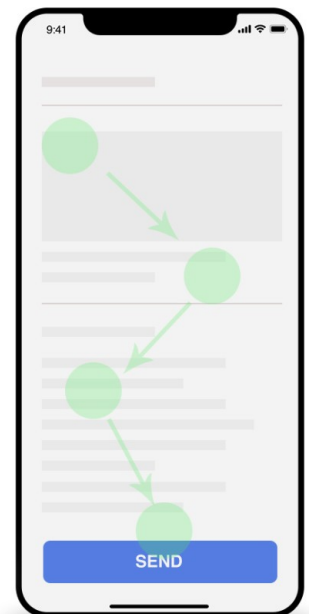
✓
GOOD



✗
BAD



✓
GOOD



✓✓
EXCELLENT

Learn the language of touch

CORE GESTURES Basic gestures for most touch commands

Tap



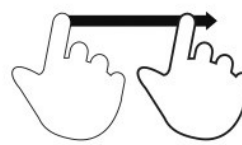
Briefly touch surface with fingertip

Double tap



Rapidly touch surface twice with fingertip

Drag



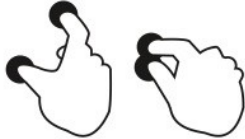
Move fingertip over surface without losing contact

Flick



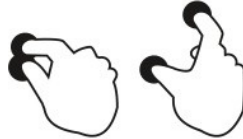
Quickly brush surface with fingertip

Pinch



Touch surface with two fingers and bring them closer together

Spread



Touch surface with two fingers and move them apart

Press



Touch surface for extended period of time

Press and tap



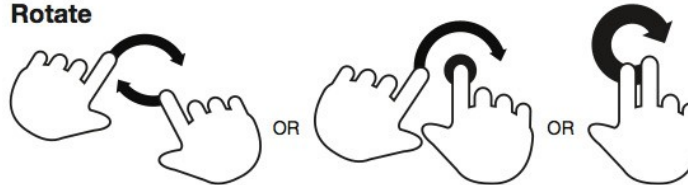
Press surface with one finger and briefly touch surface with second finger

Press and drag



Press surface with one finger and move second finger over surface without losing contact

Rotate

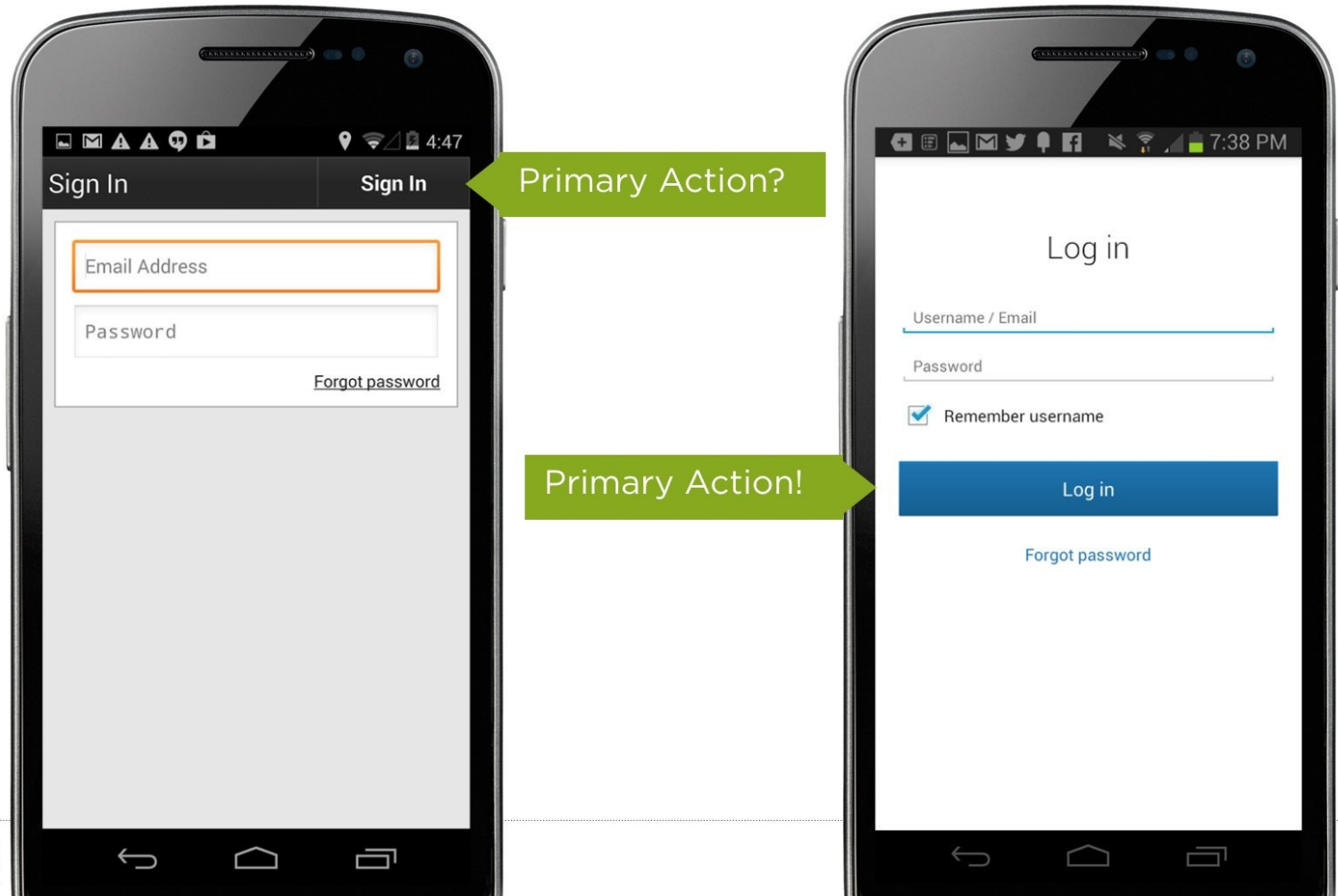


Touch surface with two fingers and move them in a clockwise or counterclockwise direction

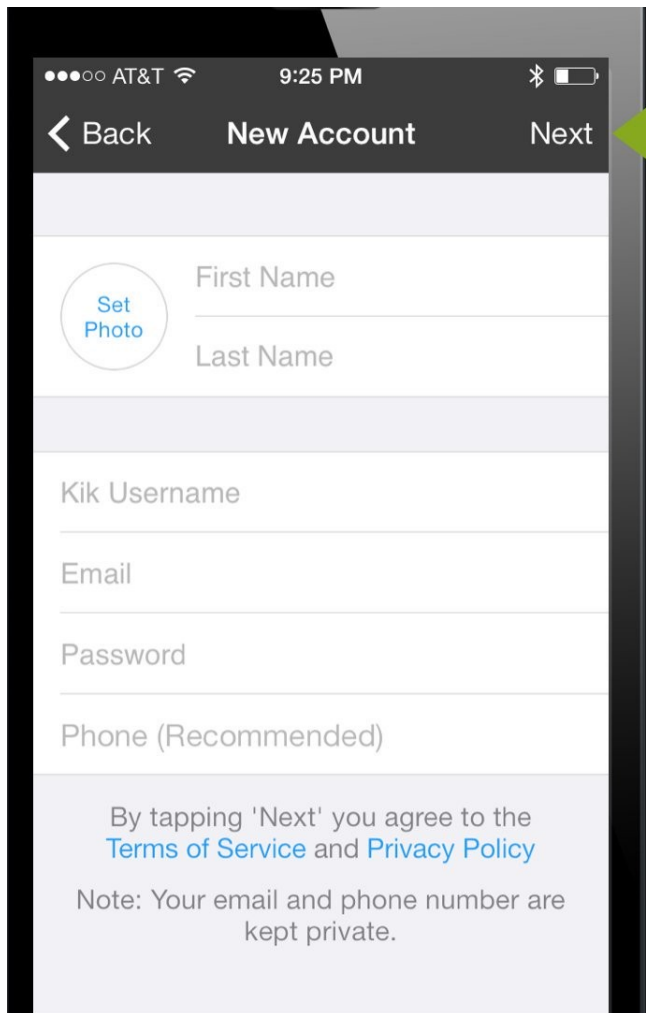
- Gestures are hidden by nature so:
 - Be consistent in your use of gestures in your applications
 - Use the most appropriate gestures based on Apple/Google guidelines and common usage patterns in applications (e.g., “pull down to refresh”)
 - Use affordances to hint at gestures and consider tutorial and invitation patterns to explain uncommon gestures
 - Test, test, test!



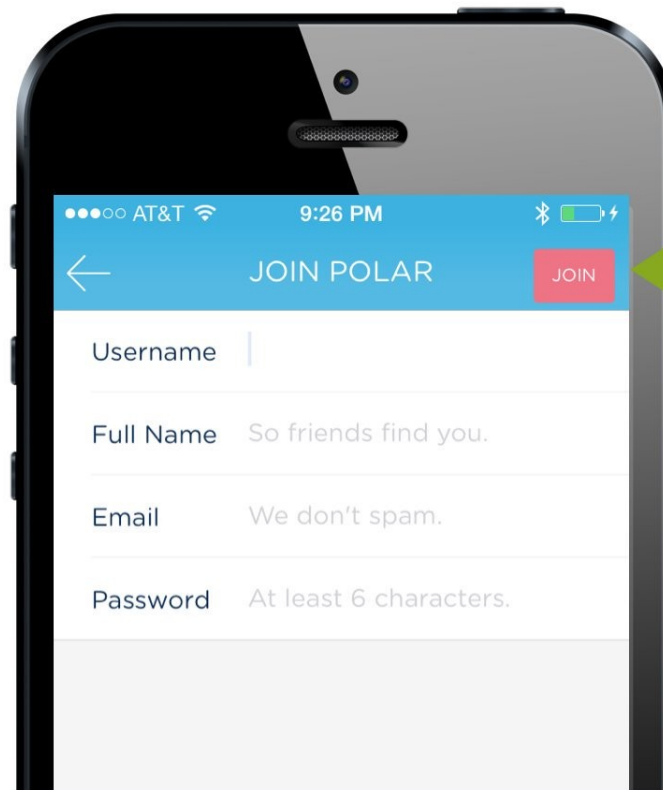
Obvious always wins



Make primary actions obvious



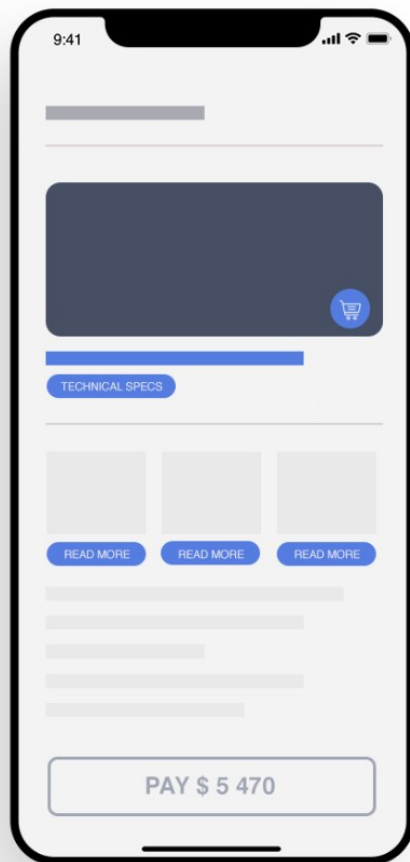
Low contrast,
little affordance



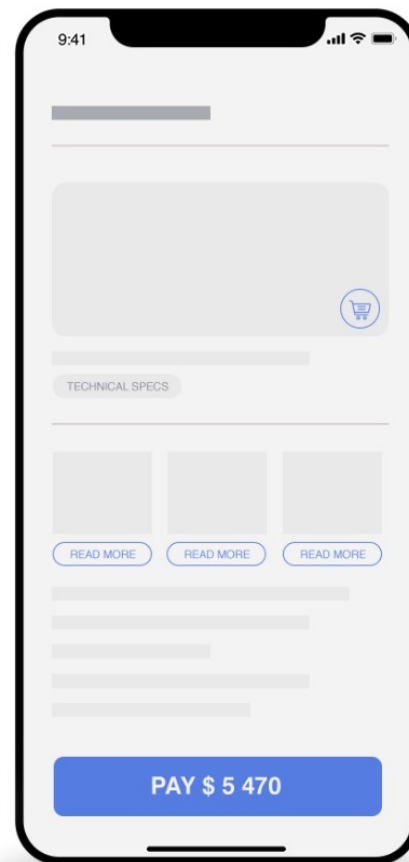
High-contrast,
button affordance

HIGH PRIORITY

LOW PRIORITY



✗
BAD



HIGH PRIORITY

✓
GOOD

LOG IN

E-mail adress

Password

LOGIN ME

SIGN UP

FORGOT PASSWORD?



LOG IN

E-mail adress

Password

LOGIN ME

SIGN UP

Forgot Password?

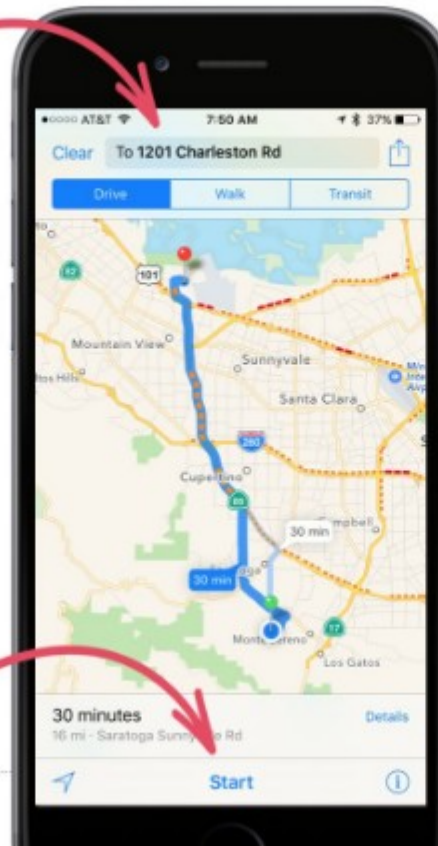


BEFORE

AFTER

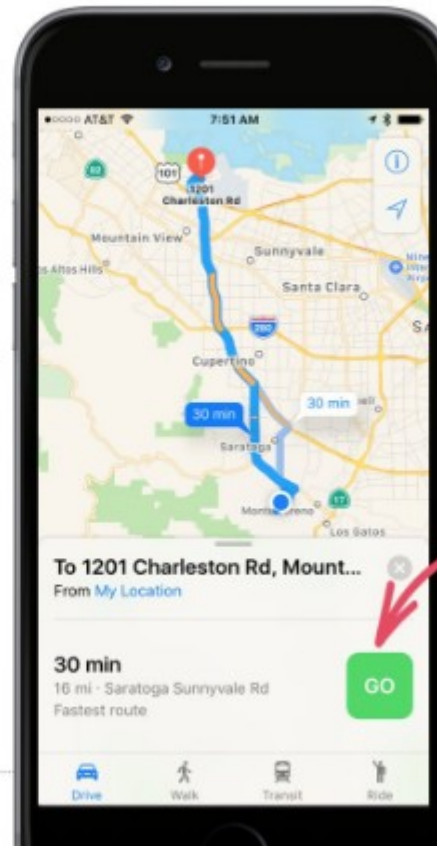
separation of related content: destination & route/action below

primary action not reflected in visual hierarchy/affordances



related content & actions no longer visually separated

clear primary action: strong visual contrast & affordance (button)



BEFORE

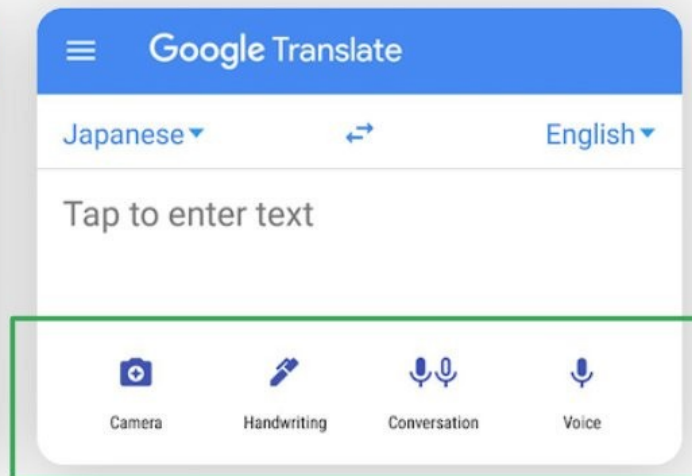
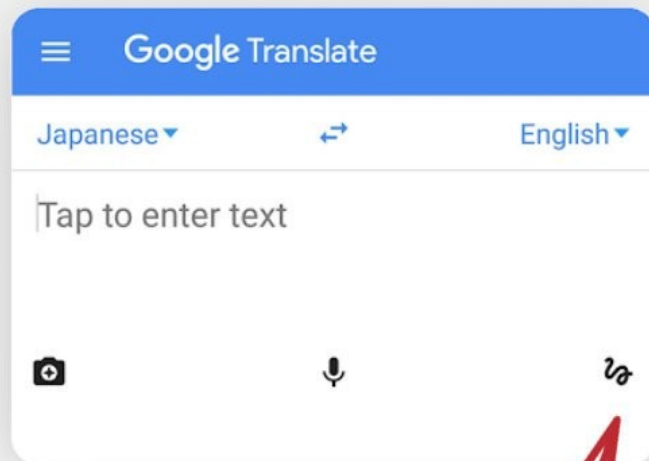


icon only

AFTER



icon & text



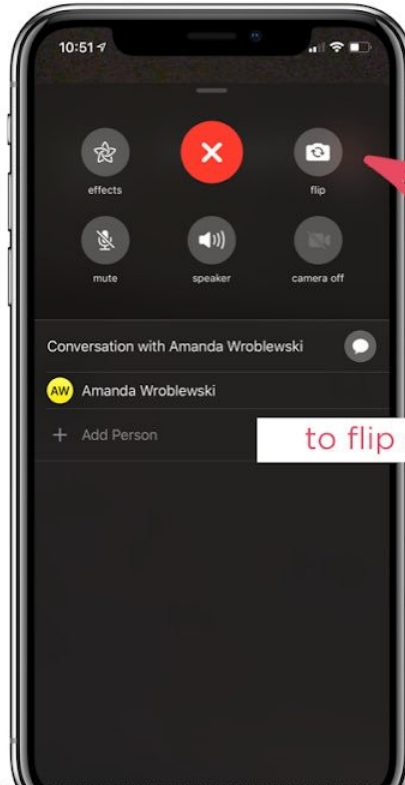
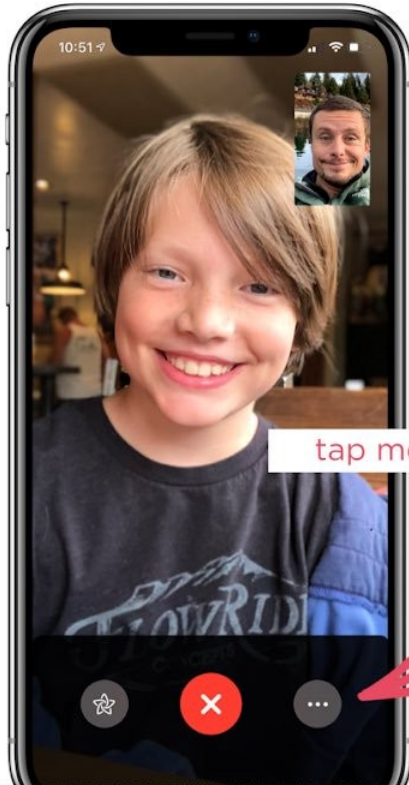
??



+25%

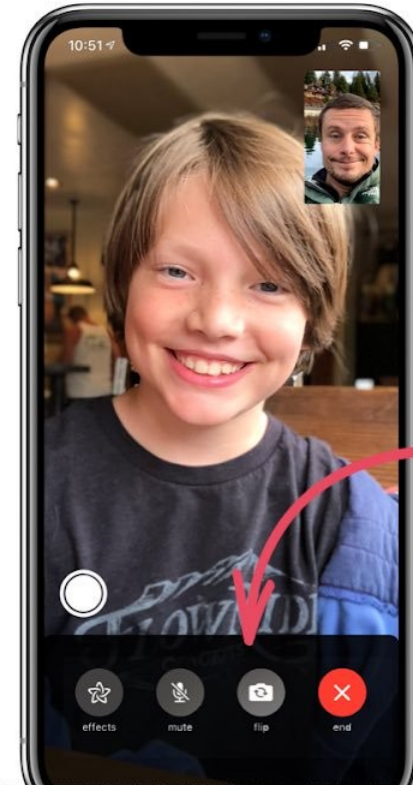
**usage of handwriting feature and
increase in usage of all features**

BEFORE



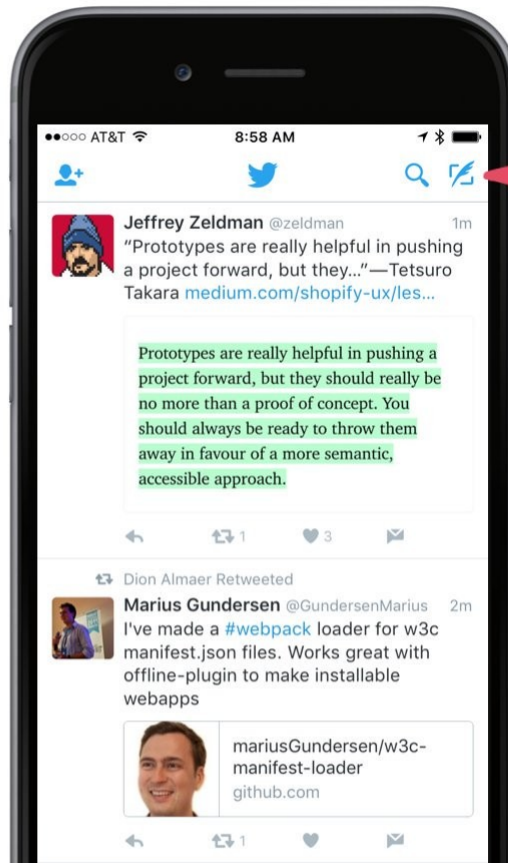
VS

AFTER



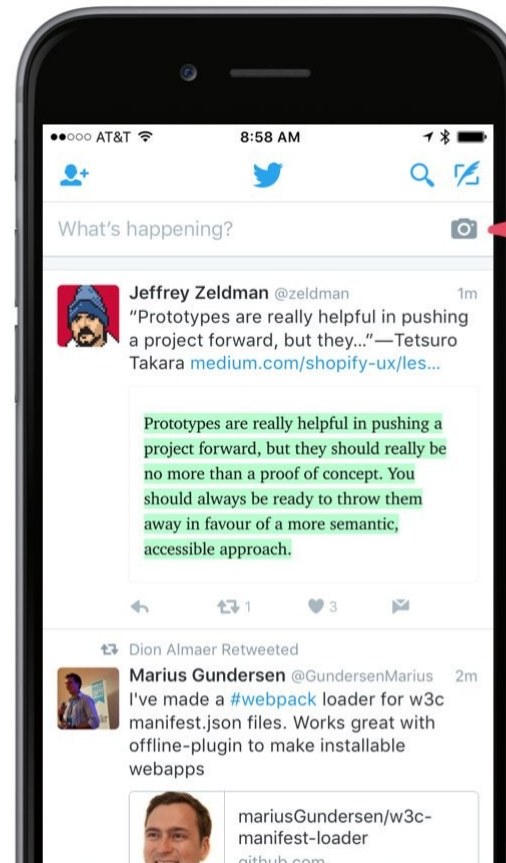
with text labels for icons

BEFORE



compose icon
to create a new
tweet

AFTER

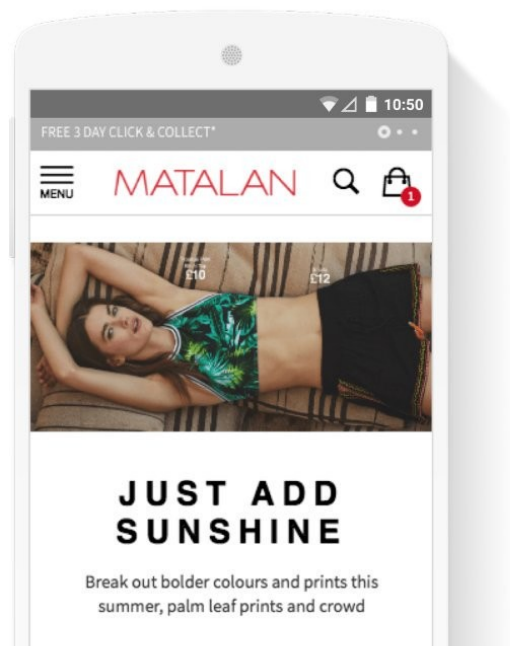


input field
label
camera icon
to create a new
tweet

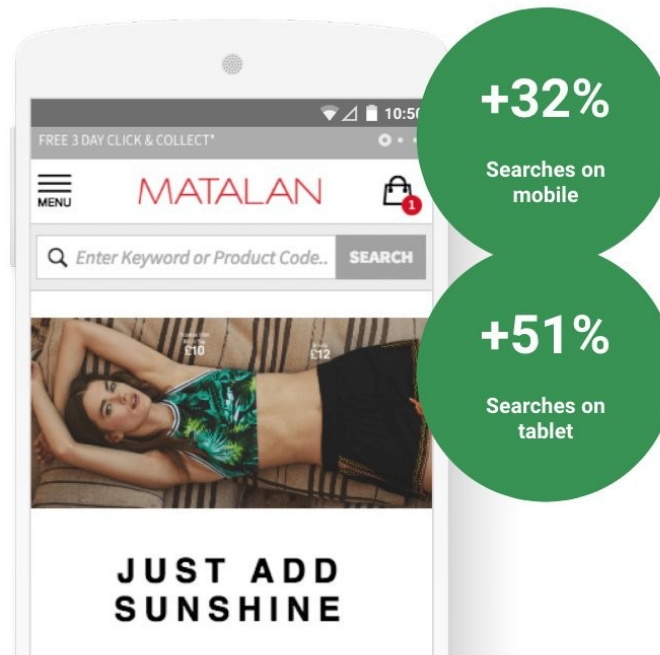
A/B test

Proprietary + Confidential

Matalan folded out the search bar



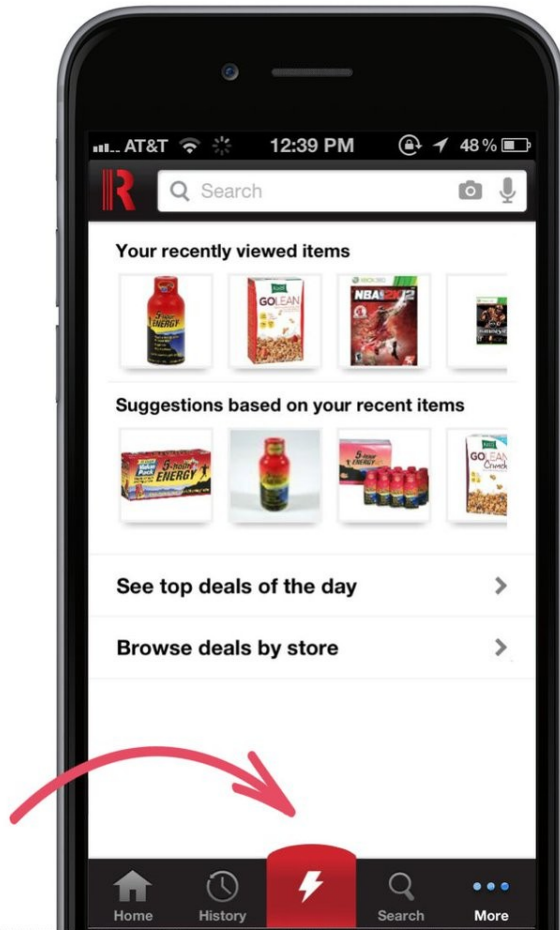
Before - Search bar not fully exposed



After - Search bar exposed on all pages

Google

... but keep your design consistent



“We made our “scan” button huge and different color from the rest of the nav menu and **users entirely ignored it.**”

Miles Skorpen

Head of Business Development, Red Laser

Obvious always wins?

“Obvious” icons are not always “universal” icons

For example, not everyone may understand the meaning of the floppy disk save icon



Obvious always wins?

This Means Search



YES

🔍 Search Inbox

NO

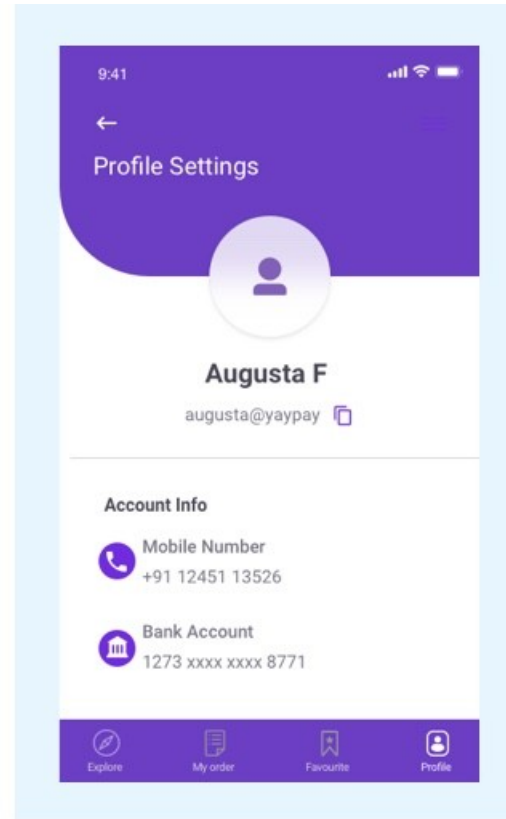
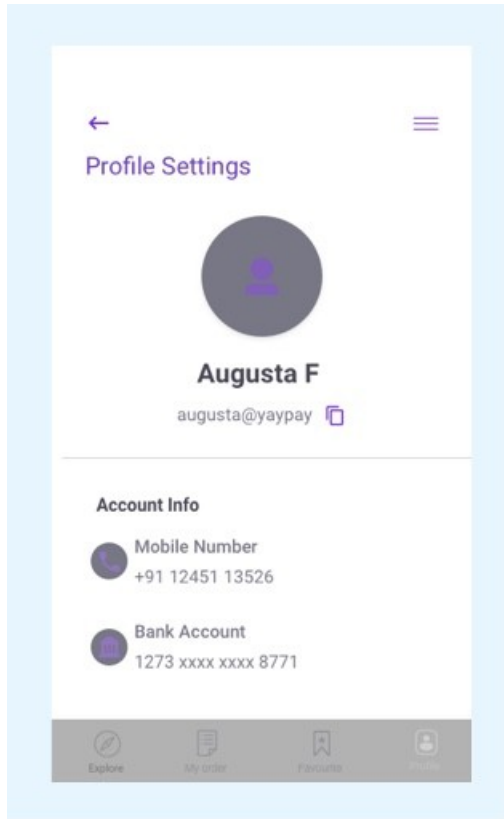


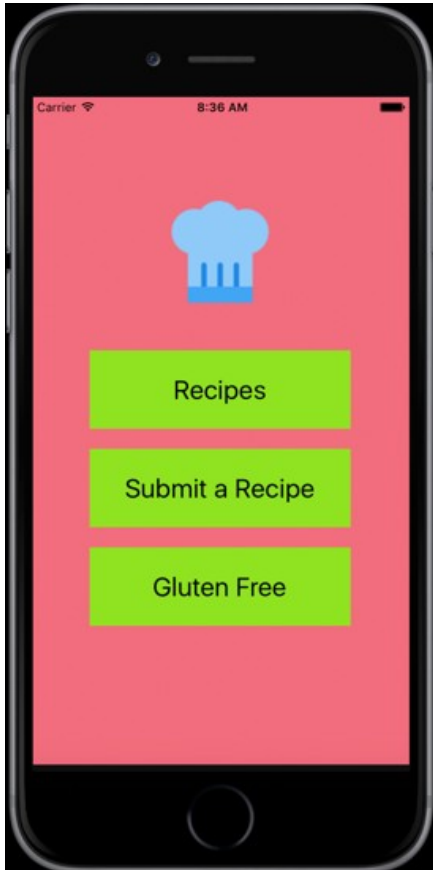
Use shapes and colors properly

Bad
iconography

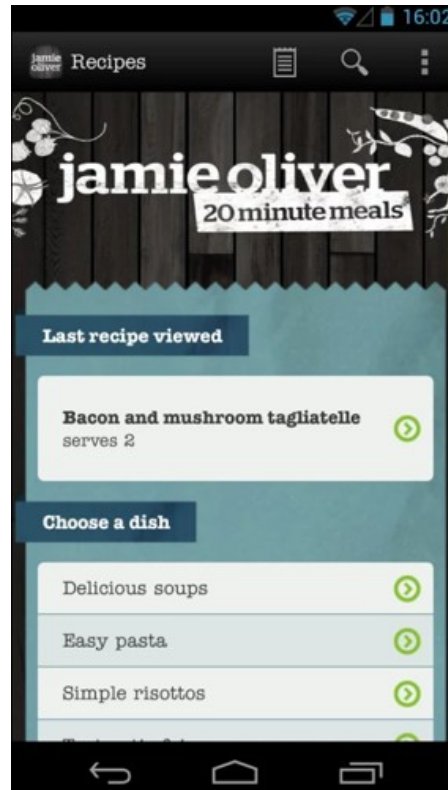


Low
contrast

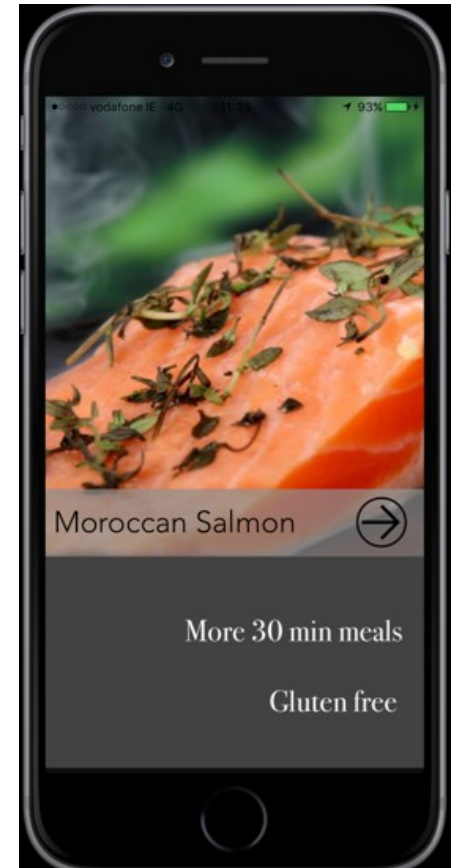




Ugly defaults

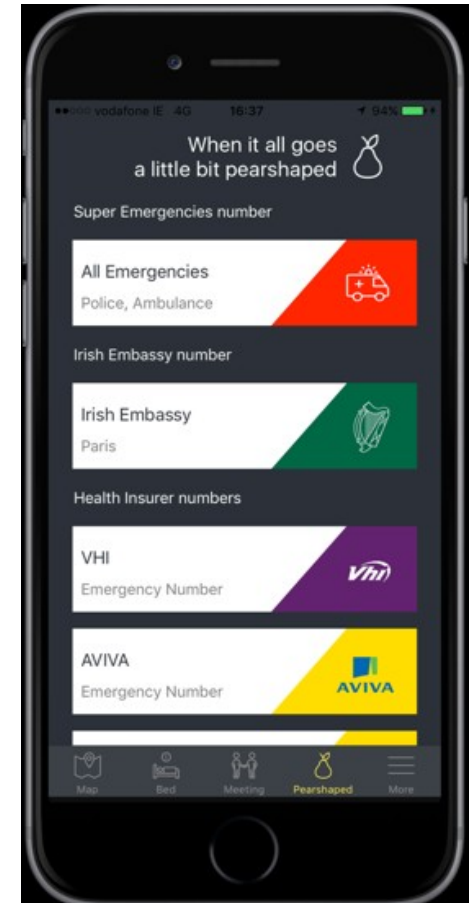
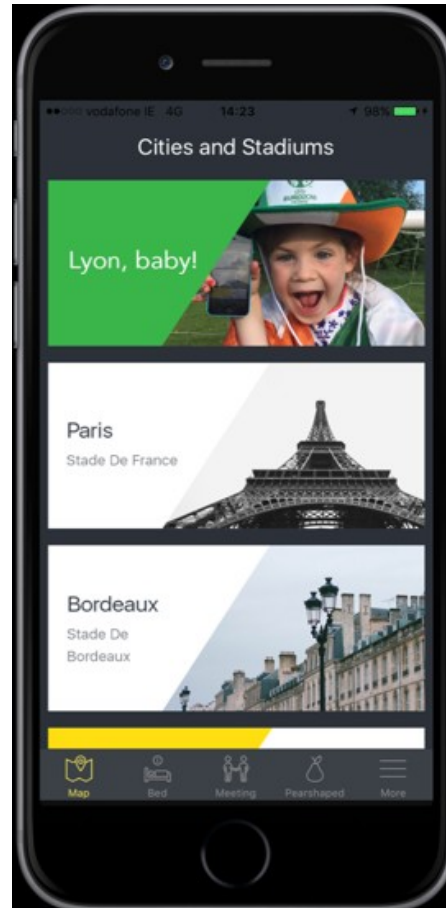


Custom look&feel





Ugly defaults



Custom look&feel

How does a designer know what is obvious or even common sense to a user?

Design is only obvious in retrospect

If you are not your target user, then you have to observe users, learn, and iterate

Spend time with users often and regularly and your designs will become more relevant, appropriate, and “obvious”